Stage 1 Background – Market Research Report v2

2026-09-22 · @Someone

Summary

The idea holds up, but v1 missed a direct competitor. Ofertautos already scrapes Yapo and Mercado Libre, estimates fair value and flags deals. It is aimed at consumers, at CLP 4,990 per month. Our space is the B2B version: tools that businesses use to buy and price cars, sold at dealer-software prices (about 1.5–9 UF per month).

This report covers the **Investigate** column of the Stage 1 map. Company details (name, history, mission, team) are created later in the deck.

What changed from v1

- **Competitors:** added Ofertautos (consumer deal finder) and GEMA (dealer software, no pricing). Confirmed what AutoGest's AI appraisal tool covers. Corrected v1's claim that no Chilean player does deal classification.
- **Product pipeline:** now matches our final definition. The regression sets the fair price and the deal label. The LLM only standardizes listing text and explains the result. Photo analysis is a new step, with a cost estimate.
- **Scrapyards:** they mostly buy at salvage auctions (for example Remates Reyco, 500+ vehicles a month), not on classifieds. Those auctions become a data source.
- **Market size:** added a revenue view (TAM/SAM/SOM in CLP) and a break-even estimate: about 42 paying clients cover a two-person tech team. Every assumption is labeled.
- **Business Model Canvas:** a new section lists the block-by-block changes.
- **Still open:** the number of target businesses. The SII company-statistics file is still blocked from this environment.

1. Business Category

We sit in **B2B automotive price intelligence**. We sell businesses a web SaaS that turns public listings and auction lots into buy and price decisions. The main Chilean players sell something else: vehicle-history reports, listing space or dealer-management software.

Ofertautos is the only verified deal finder, and it serves consumers.

Data sources

Source	What it is	Size seen (22 Sep 2026)	Crawling policy
Chileautos	Largest classifieds site; owned by Australia's carsales.com since 2016, 100% since Dec 2018 (LexLatin)	70,039 vehicles listed	robots.txt blocks /vehiculos; terms of use ban automated extraction
Yapo.cl	General classifieds site; says it is Chile's #1 used-car platform	34,032 used-car listings	robots.txt allows listing pages
Mercado Libre Autos	Marketplace with a vehicle category	Not verifiable	robots.txt blocks automated access
Kavak	Buys, reconditions and resells used cars; 500+ cars at its Macul hub (Chócale)	Page blocks automated access	Not checked
Remates Reyco	**New.** Says it is Chile's largest auction house for damaged vehicles; bidding is 100% online	"Más de 500 vehículos mes a mes"	Not checked
Vedisa Remates	**New.** Online auctions of damaged vehicles, including a "Desarme" (for dismantling) category	No volume stated	Not checked

Competitors and substitutes

Player	What it offers	Price	Overlap with us
Ofertautos	**New.** Scans Yapo and Mercado Libre every 6 hours and estimates a market-value index. Shows only listings below market value and emails daily alerts. Tracks 5,290 cars across 326 models	Free search; alerts CLP 4,990 per month	**Closest local match.** Serves consumers, covers only 2 portals and no salvage auctions, has no photo analysis
AutoGest	Dealer management software with an "AI appraiser" (brand, model, year, mileage, condition, region) and analysis of which portal sells best	CLP 59,990 per month, single plan, 10-day trial	Built-in appraisals for small dealers; no market-wide deal feed
Autofact / Autofact Pro	Commercial value lookup by plate or model; history reports. For dealers: trade-in tools and digital ownership transfers	Per report / B2B	Same dealer buyers; no deal scoring or alerts
GEMA	**New.** Dealer software for inventory, CRM and leads (Motordesk.ai), plus AI car photography	From CLP 99,900 per month	Same buyers; no pricing product. Possible partner
CarGurus (US, reference)	Instant Market Value from comparable listings; five deal ratings	—	The model we adapt; not in Chile
Manual research	Staff browsing portals and keeping spreadsheets	Staff time	The status quo we replace

What this means for us: we differentiate on three things.

1. Built for businesses: team seats, a price search by year and mileage, and valuations of specific cars.
2. More sources: every portal that allows crawling, plus salvage auctions.

3. Photo-based condition pricing, which no competitor offers.

2. History context

The used-car market moved online over the last decade. Foreign capital bought the largest classifieds site, digital-first dealers arrived, and nearly every household is now connected. These dated facts can anchor the founder story we create.

Date	Event	Source
2026	Ofertautos is live, offering AI deal alerts to consumers	Ofertautos
2025	E-commerce reaches about US$10 billion, +9% real growth, 12.6% of retail	CCS
2025	AWS announces a US$4 billion cloud region in Chile	Amazon
2024	96.5% of households have internet access	Subtel via CPI
Sep 2024	Kavak opens an 18,000 m² hub in Macul	Chócale
Dec 2018	carsales.com takes 100% of Chileautos	LexLatin
Mar 2016	carsales.com buys 83% of Chileautos for US$15M	LexLatin

3. Vision and Mission: competitor references

Every reference player talks about trust and closing the information gap, and speaks to consumers. Ours should speak to businesses and to decisions: buy it, price it, sell it.

Company	Statement (verbatim)	Audience
Autofact (Chile, founded 2012)	Purpose: "eliminar la asimetría de información en el mercado de vehículos usados"	Consumers and dealers
Kavak	"We want to empower people by helping them solve everything related to one of their most important assets: their car."	Consumers

Company	Statement (verbatim)	Audience
CarGurus (US)	"bring more trust and transparency to car shopping"	Consumers

Draft direction for our mission: *"Give every car business the market price of any car before it buys."*

4. Business Model: benchmarks and feasibility

Chilean dealer software already sells for about 1.5–9 UF per month, and our AI costs stay under US$100 per month. That leaves room for a Basic plan at about 2 UF and a Pro plan at about 5 UF. The binding constraint is legal: the largest portal bans automated extraction.

Pricing benchmarks (UF = CLP 40,991.75 on 22 Sep 2026, mindicador.cl)

Product	What it sells	Price per month	Source
Vendicar	Dealer management: inventory, CRM, web publishing	1.5 / 3 / 6 / 9 UF + VAT (about CLP 61k–369k); tiers by users and cars	vendicar.cl
GEMA Motordesk.ai	Dealer CRM, leads, messaging	From CLP 99,900 (about 2.4 UF)	go-gema.com
AutoGest	Dealer management with an AI appraiser	CLP 59,990 (about 1.5 UF); CLP 49,998 per month on 6-month billing	autogest.cl
Ofertautos	Consumer deal alerts	CLP 4,990	ofertautos.cl
Chileautos	Price per car listing	CLP 5,900–9,400; up to CLP 65,900 Premium Pro	Chileautos help centre

Product pipeline (updated to our final definition)

```
flowchart LR
    A[Portals + salvage<br/>auctions + client feeds] --> B[Scrapers]
    B --> C[LLM extraction<br/>standard fields]
    C --> D[Regression<br/>fair-price range]
    D --> E[Deal label<br/>asking vs fair]
    P[Client photos] --> V[Vision model<br/>damage adjustment]
    V --> D
    E --> F[Web app: alerts,<br/>price search, valuation]
```

The regression, not the LLM, sets the price. It estimates a fair-price range from brand, model, version, year, mileage, fuel, transmission and region. The deal label then compares the asking price with that range, the way CarGurus does. The LLM turns messy listing text into standard fields and writes a one-line reason. The vision model reads photos a client uploads and lowers the estimate for visible damage.

AI running costs

Task	Assumption	Monthly cost
Standardizing listing text	100,000 listings, 800 input + 150 output tokens each, batch pricing	US$17 (GPT-5.6 Luna) to US$78 (Claude Haiku 4.5), per v1 (OpenAI, Gemini, Claude)
Photo analysis (new)	10 photos per car, about 1,500 tokens per photo (**our assumption**), list prices	About US$0.004 (Gemini Flash-Lite) to US$0.017 (Claude Haiku 4.5) per car; under US$2 for a Pro client's 100 analyses

Legal and technical feasibility

- **Chileautos:** its terms of use prohibit "la utilización de cualquier proceso automatizado… para consultar, acceder, recuperar, extraer datos". Access needs a data-licensing agreement.
- **Yapo:** robots.txt allows listing pages. Its terms of use have not been reviewed yet.
- **Mercado Libre:** robots.txt blocks automated access to its autos site. Ofertautos says it scans Mercado Libre, so an official API or partnership route may exist; to verify.
- **Salvage auctions:** online catalogues that allow bidding once you register. To check each site's terms, or approach them as partners.

- **Personal data:** Ley 21.719 takes effect on 1 Dec 2026, with fines up to 20,000 UTM; small companies get warnings instead of fines until Dec 2027. Seller names and phone numbers are personal data; car specs and prices are not.

What this means for the business model: collect vehicle data only, start with sources that allow crawling, negotiate licences with Chileautos and Mercado Libre, and let clients connect their own stock feeds.

5. Structure and Infrastructure: reference costs

People are the main cost; infrastructure is cheap. An MVP stack fits in about US$100–200 per month, while one semi-senior data scientist costs CLP 2.8–4.2M gross per month. About **42 paying clients** would cover a two-person paid tech team.

Cloud (supplier) reference prices

Item	Price	Source
Virtual server, 2 GB RAM / 1 vCPU	US$12 per month	DigitalOcean
Virtual server, 4 GB RAM / 2 vCPU	US$24 per month	DigitalOcean
Virtual server, 8 GB RAM / 4 vCPU	US$48 per month	DigitalOcean
AI: listing text + photos	About US$20–80 per month	Section 4

AWS announced a US$4 billion Chile region planned for end-2026 (Amazon); it has had Local Zones in Santiago since 2023 (AWS blog). Hosting in Chile lowers latency and makes Ley 21.719 compliance easier.

Salaries, Santiago, gross CLP per month (P25–P75, IT Workers 2026 guide)

Role	Junior	Semi-senior	Senior
Backend / full-stack developer	0.8–1.2M	1.8–2.8M	2.8–4.2M
Data engineer	1.2–1.8M	2.8–4.0M	4.0–6.0M
Data scientist / ML engineer	1.2–1.8M	2.8–4.2M	4.2–6.5M

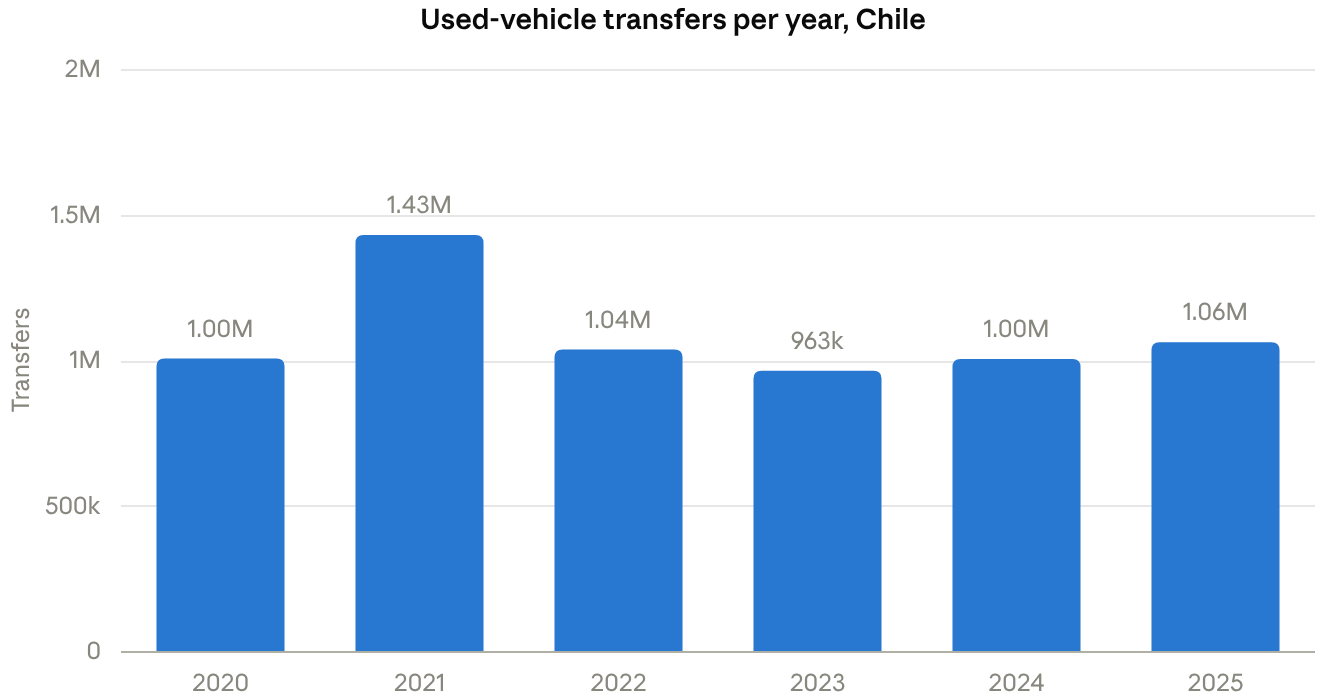
Break-even estimate (our assumptions)

Item	Value	Basis
Full-stack developer, semi-senior	CLP 2.3M	Midpoint of the range above
Data scientist, semi-senior	CLP 3.5M	Midpoint of the range above
Cloud + AI	CLP 0.2M	About US$200 at roughly CLP 950 per US$ (assumption)
Monthly cost	**CLP 6.0M**	Founders' time and B2B sales not paid
Average revenue per client	CLP 143,471	3.5 UF, a Basic/Pro mix (assumption)
Clients to break even	**42**	6.0M ÷ 143,471

No verified salary source was found for sales or marketing roles, so the model assumes the founders handle sales.

6. Current Situation: the market

Chile's used-car market is large and stable: 1,060,919 used transfers in 2025 (+5.8%), about 3.4 used cars for every new one. 2026 is on track to pass one million again, with 736,120 transfers from January to August (REDIMIN).



CAVEM via REDIMIN. 2021 spike = post-pandemic demand

CAVEM via REDIMIN · 2020–2025

Indicator	Value	Source
Used transfers bought by companies, Aug 2026	14,231 of 87,748 (16.2%)	PressLatam, citing CAVEM
New vehicle sales 2025	310,598 (+2.7%)	Diario Estrategia, citing ANAC
Used cars sold per new car	3.4 in 2025; 3.5 Jan–Aug 2026	Autofact, REDIMIN
Vehicles in circulation 2024	6,727,472 permits (+2.9%); 36.8% in the Metropolitan Region	Cooperativa, citing INE
Average asking price on Chileautos	CLP 18,396,548 in 2025 vs 17,527,519 in 2024 (+5%)	Emol
Searches on Chileautos, 2025	142 million	24horas
Damaged vehicles auctioned by Reyco	500+ per month	Remates Reyco

Prices vary widely, which is the core case for our product. One model, the Ford F-150, was listed on Chileautos in 2025 at anywhere from CLP 2,000,000 to CLP 68,900,000 (Emol). Segments also moved differently: hatchbacks +5%, pickups +4%, sedans +3%,

SUVs slightly down. Nobody can judge a price without comparable cars of the same model.

No verified data exists on how many Chilean dealers use SaaS tools. Paid dealer tools (Vendicar, AutoGest, GEMA, Autofact Pro) show they are willing to pay for software.

7. Scope: where and how big

The data backs a Santiago-first launch: the Metropolitan Region makes up 58% of used transfers. Businesses buy about one used car in six. Implied B2B subscription revenue is roughly CLP 1.6–4.9 billion a year nationally. Winning 5% of Santiago buyers is about 41 clients, close to the break-even point in Section 5.

Scope indicators

Indicator	Value	Source
Used transfers in the Metropolitan Region, 2025	615,311 (58.0%); next: Valparaíso 70,983, Biobío 62,191	CAVEM Anuario 2025
Share of used cars bought by companies	16.2% (Aug 2026)	PressLatam
Transferred cars aged 16+ years, 2025 (supply for scrapyards)	252,405 (23.8%)	CAVEM Anuario 2025
Transferred cars aged 0–5 years, 2025 (dealership trade-ins)	273,033 (25.7%)	CAVEM Anuario 2025

Market size, transaction view

- **TAM:** 1,060,919 used transfers a year in Chile, each one a pricing decision.
- **SAM:** about 172,000 a year bought by companies (16.2% of 2025 transfers), about 14,300 a month. These are the purchases our B2B clients make.
- **SOM, Santiago:** 58% of SAM, about 100,000 business purchases a year.

Market size, revenue view (new; our assumptions)

No verified count of target businesses exists, so we back out how many buyers the 14,300 monthly company purchases imply. The key assumption is how many cars one business buys a month. Some company purchases are fleets and leasing firms, so treat the results as an upper bound.

Scenario	Cars bought per business per month	Implied professional buyers	Annual revenue at 3.5 UF/month
High	5	~2,870	~CLP 4.9 billion
Base	10	~1,430	~CLP 2.5 billion
Low	15	~960	~CLP 1.6 billion

In the base case, Santiago has about 830 buyers (58%). A year-1 target of 5% is about **41 clients**, or roughly CLP 71M in annual recurring revenue. The scenario is simple arithmetic on CAVEM totals; replace it with the SII business count once that file is available.

8. Main Actions: competitor references

The incumbents market mostly through press studies built on their own data, content and free trials. That playbook suits a data startup that can publish its own price findings.

Company	Observed action	Source
Chileautos	Press studies built on its own listing data, e.g. "20 most-listed used cars that dropped in price" (Sep 2024); a 2025 price review fronted by its CEO	El Mostrador, Emol
Chileautos	Campus Chileautos: training for dealers	Help centre
Autofact	Consumer blog content: market reviews, dealer directories, scrapyard guides	Autofact blog
Autofact Pro	B2B site naming dealer clients (Derco, Rosselot, Kovacs), with testimonials	autofactpro.com
Ofertautos	Free search and appraiser; pays off through a CLP 4,990 alerts plan with a 7-day trial; SEO pages by brand	ofertautos.cl
AutoGest	10-day free trial; discounts for quarterly and semi-annual billing	autogest.cl
Vendicar	No minimum contract, 2-day setup, WhatsApp support 24/7	vendicar.cl

Company	Observed action	Source
Kavak	Physical experience centre in Macul, launched with press coverage	Chócale

Launch actions this suggests for us

- A free monthly "Price index" press report built from our data, copying the Chileautos playbook.
- A 14-day free trial, which matches the market norm of 7–10 days.
- Field visits to used-car dealers and scrapyards in Santiago, plus a presence at salvage auctions.
- Partnerships with dealer-software vendors (GEMA, Vendicar) so our prices appear inside their tools.

Implications for the Business Model Canvas

Six of the nine blocks change. The biggest changes are a sharper value proposition against Ofertautos and AutoGest, salvage auctions as a key partner, and a revenue model tied to dealer-software prices.

Canvas block	Change	Evidence
Value Propositions	Lead with "B2B, every source, photo-adjusted price". Consumers can already get deal alerts from Ofertautos	Section 1
Customer Segments	Keep the 3 B2B segments. Scrapyards are served mainly through salvage-auction data. Private buyers move lower: Ofertautos already serves them for CLP 4,990	Sections 1, 4
Key Partners	Add salvage auctions (Reyco, Vedisa), dealer-software vendors (GEMA, Vendicar) and data licences (Chileautos, Mercado Libre)	Sections 1, 4, 8

Canvas block	Change	Evidence
Key Activities	The regression sets price and deal label; the LLM only standardizes and explains	Section 4
Revenue Streams	Basic ~2 UF, Pro ~5 UF, Enterprise on quote, all in line with Vendicar (1.5–9 UF) and GEMA (~2.4 UF). Add a 14-day trial	Sections 4, 8
Cost Structure	About CLP 6.0M a month with two paid engineers; break-even at about 42 clients	Section 5
Channels, Customer Relationships, Key Resources	No change; the monthly price report is confirmed as a channel	Section 8

Open items and source log

- [ ] Count desarmadurías, compraventas and concesionarias from SII company statistics. The file is blocked from this environment; download it by hand.
- [ ] Review Yapo's terms of use and each salvage-auction site's terms.
- [ ] Confirm how Ofertautos accesses Mercado Libre data (API or partnership).
- [ ] Test the 2 UF / 5 UF plans in 5–10 dealer interviews.

Every source above was opened on 22 Sep 2026 and the quoted figure was found on the page. Sources excluded or not usable:

Source	Result	Treatment
SII company statistics file	Blocked by this environment's network	Open item; revenue view uses scenarios
The Clinic / PasionMotor (Jun 2026)	991,431 transfers; contradicts CAVEM	Excluded
Autofact dealer directory	Lists only top-rated dealers, not a total	Not used for counts
Diario Financiero (Oct 2020)	No dealer count; outdated	Not cited

Source	Result	Treatment
Chileautos results page, Kavak listings	HTTP 403	Homepage total and press article used
Chile SaaS market reports	Paywalled	Not cited